

My power bill has almost doubled because of AI.

Posted by u/Smart_Opportunity631 • • 0 points • 18 comments

I've seen my energy bills skyrocket over the past two years. I keep reading about the massive energy needs from more and more AI centers popping up and I'm curious as to why the cost of running these things is being passed on to the basic consumer? I'm sure companies are paying a boat load of money for power as well but it feels like the buck was passed to average joe.

I get that power companies are needing to expand and increase production to keep up with demand but I fail to see why I should be paying almost 2x as much as two years ago because Microsoft wants to force feed me co-pilot. These billion dollar companies should be paying for the infrastructure not the people.

Comments

u/NoStupidQuestionsBot • 1 points • 2025-12-03 09:51 UTC

Thanks for your submission /u/Smart_Opportunity631, but it has been removed for the following reason:

Disallowed question area: ****Rant or loaded question****

NoStupidQuestions is a place to ask any question as long as ***it's asked in good faith***. Our users routinely report questions that they feel violate this rule to us. Want to avoid your question being seen as a bad faith question? Common mistakes include (but are not limited to):

* Rants: Could your question be answered with ***"That's awful"** or ***"What an asshole"***? Then it's probably a rant rather than a genuine question. Looking for a place to vent on Reddit? Try /r/TrueOffMyChest or /r/Rant instead.

* Loaded questions: Could your question be answered with ***"You're right"***? Answering the question yourself, explaining your reasoning for your opinion, or making sweeping assumptions about the question itself all signals that you may not be keeping an open mind. Want to know why people have a different opinion than you? Try /r/ExplainBothSides instead!

* Arguments: Arguing or [sealioning](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sea_lioning) with people giving you answers tells everyone that you have an answer in mind already. Want a good debate? Try

/r/ChangeMyView instead!

* Pot Stirring: Did you bring up unnecessary topics in your question? Especially when a topic has to do with already controversial issues like politics, race, gender or sex, this can be seen as trying to score points against the Other Side - and that makes people defensive, which leads to arguments. Questions like *"If _____ is allowed, why isn't _____?"* don't need to have that comparison - just ask *"why isn't _____ allowed?"*.

* Complaining about moderation: If you disagree with how the sub is run or a decision the mods have made, that's fine! But please share your thoughts with us in modmail rather than as a public post.

Disagree with the mods? If you believe you asked your question in good faith, try rewording it or message the mods to see if there's a way you could ask more neutrally. Thanks for your understanding!

This action was performed by a bot at the explicit direction of a human. This was not an automated action, but a conscious decision by a sapient life form charged with moderating this sub.

If you feel this was in error, or need more clarification, please don't hesitate to [message the moderators](<http://www.reddit.com/message/compose?to=%2Fr%2FNoStupidQuestions>). Thanks.

u/Uodda • 1 points • 2025-12-03 07:50 UTC

It's kinda basic marketing economy, the more of something needed to more consumers, the more it costs, if demand even higher than production, it become even more.

u/Felicia_Svilling • 1 points • 2025-12-03 06:42 UTC

> I'm curious as to why the cost of running these things is being passed on to the basic consumer?

I would guess that is because you live in a market economy.

u/LurkingInTheDoorway • 8 points • 2025-12-03 06:39 UTC

This is some paranoid ass bullshit. Like claiming the bitcoin miners are driving up the power industry costs. Lol

u/Ryeeeeebread • 1 points • 2025-12-03 08:13 UTC

? I've been hearing this alot i thought it was common knowledge

<https://www.cnbc.com/2025/11/26/ai-data-center-frenzy-is-pushing-up-your-electric-bill-heres-why.html>

u/Koooooj • 1 points • 2025-12-03 06:11 UTC

Power is bought and sold wholesale on a real-time market. The idea here is that the grid has minimal ability to store energy, so you really need production to match demand. When more people demand power the price raises until enough generation capacity comes online to meet it.

AI showing up as a new big demand on the grid naturally causes wholesale prices to go up. It would be like if you enjoy sweet potatoes and one day every fast food restaurant decided to shift from potato fries to sweet potato fries. The demand would quickly outstrip supply and the price goes up to find a new equilibrium. Yes, those restaurants would pay more for their sweet potatoes, but if the prevailing belief among executives is that the winner of the sweet potato race will dominate the market for a generation

then they'll happily pay those prices.

That's not to say that this is the only thing affecting your prices, but it is the mechanism by which AI computing power demands play their role.

u/rewardiflost • 1 points • 2025-12-03 06:06 UTC

That's the way markets work.

You aren't directly paying for the AI energy bill. Those companies get an electric bill just like everyone else does.

But, because it is really expensive and difficult to build new generation facilities, they aren't getting built often enough or fast enough. Few people will volunteer to have a new power plant built in their neighborhood. So we are all stuck with a fairly fixed amount of power generation available.

When demand for power goes up and nobody is able to make or distribute more power to meet those demands, then they have to (or even without absolutely needing to - they do) increase the costs. When lots of different consumers all want a limited resource, the price goes up - those willing to pay more get more; those who can cut back will cut back; those who have to use it and can't cut back any more get screwed and just have to pay more.

In the US, at least, we aren't building new power generation sources anywhere near the demand needs. Our infrastructure is barely enough (but technically - yes, enough) to handle the demand as long as nothing goes wrong and maintenance stays current. That's a poor plan, and we can see several areas where distribution is failing, causing fires, causing blackouts and otherwise crapping out.

Our bills are usually split between the cost of power and the cost of delivery. If we were only paying increases for infrastructure, the increases would be in the delivery side. Most of us are paying increases in both - instead of building new generation, we are auctioning power off regionally now.

Companies are buying/selling power months in advance and bidding against each other for that. We are paying rates that reflect how much power we have to buy on the open market - and how much competition & demand there is driving those prices up.

u/Smart_Opportunity631 • 1 points • 2025-12-03 06:17 UTC

This actually explains a lot. Thank you!

u/KermieKona • -8 points • 2025-12-03 06:04 UTC

Actually... AI can reduce your power bill...

20 Ways to Reduce Your Electricity Bill (by ChatGPT)

1. Switch to LED bulbs.
2. Unplug devices when not in use to avoid phantom power.
3. Use power strips to cut off standby power easily.
4. Adjust your thermostat a few degrees (up in summer, down in winter).
5. Use fans instead of air conditioning when possible.
6. Wash laundry in cold water.
7. Air-dry clothes or use low-heat dryer settings.
8. Run the dishwasher only when full and use the air-dry setting.

9. Turn off lights when leaving a room.
10. Keep blinds/curtains closed during hot sunny hours.
11. Seal air leaks around windows, doors, and vents.
12. Clean or replace HVAC filters regularly.
13. Use a smart or programmable thermostat.
14. Keep your fridge at 37–40°F and freezer at 0–5°F.
15. Don't block vents or return air intakes.
16. Use smaller appliances (microwave, air fryer) instead of the oven.
17. Take shorter or cooler showers if you have an electric water heater.
18. Upgrade to Energy Star appliances when replacing old ones.
19. Limit or avoid electric space heaters — they use lots of energy.
20. Turn off your computer or use sleep mode when you're not using it.

u/Smart_Opportunity631 • 0 points • 2025-12-03 06:25 UTC

Funny that an AI came up with that list based on the topic. We do most of these things already. LED lights, line dry things in summer, motion sensor lights in bathrooms to ensure they aren't left on. Also who doesn't keep their fridge in the safe zone for food?!?!

We are also on gas for our water heater/stove and we have not seen the same rate hike.

u/Material_Ad_2970 • 5 points • 2025-12-03 06:14 UTC

"Here is how to live a smaller, less satisfying life so that this guy can consult me to respond to your Reddit comment."

u/SpuriusThought • 1 points • 2025-12-03 05:53 UTC

"Never seen a miracle of science that hasn't changed from a blessing to a curse." Sting

u/Exciting-Art6117 • 5 points • 2025-12-03 05:52 UTC

Your bill didn't double because Microsoft built a data center. your utility hiked rates, and they're using 'increased demand' as the excuse

u/cherry_dreamsss • 1 points • 2025-12-03 05:50 UTC

AI tech should pay for its own energy costs. 💡

u/Sternenschweif4a • 12 points • 2025-12-03 05:50 UTC

How do you know that that's what's driving up your bill...?

u/Smart_Opportunity631 • -9 points • 2025-12-03 05:55 UTC

Well I don't know for sure and I guess that's why I'm posting here. I keep reading about it and I do know data centers are a massive energy draw. So my question is how can an almost 50% rate increase per year be justified by the power company?

u/barugosamaa • 3 points • 2025-12-03 06:52 UTC

>data centers are a massive energy draw.

Not to the point of increasing your bill tho

>So my question is how can an almost 50% rate increase per year be justified by the power company?

Your company simply sucks. If they keep raising that much. But it's not because of data centers for AI....

u/notkairyssdal • 2 points • 2025-12-03 06:27 UTC

profits